

Scoring rubric

Six criteria, 1 to 4 each, 24 points. Bands: 6 to 11 needs intervention, 12 to 17 developing, 18 to 21 secure, 22 to 24 excellent.

Criterion	1	2	3	4
Letter formation	Many letters malformed or reversed, drawn in pieces	Several letters malformed, some reversals	Most letters correct, a few inconsistencies	All letters formed correctly and the same way each time
Size and proportion	No difference between tall, small and tail letters	Sizes inconsistent, some distinction	Sizes mostly correct, occasional slips	Tall, small and tail letters clearly and consistently sized
Baseline	Letters float or sink throughout	Frequent floating or sinking	Mostly on the line	Every letter sits on the line
Spacing	Words run together or gaps are random	Spacing uneven, some words touch	Mostly even, a few tight or wide gaps	Even letter spacing, clear word spaces
Slant and consistency	Slant changes letter by letter	Slant varies within words	Mostly consistent	One consistent slant throughout
Legibility	A stranger cannot read most of it	Readable with effort	Readable with occasional hesitation	Readable at first glance

Score the pre-test the same day, before you have seen the student write anything else. Same passage, same time limit on Day 10. Show each student the two samples side by side on Day 10.

Class tracking sheet

One line per student. Hand (L or R). Pre score Day 1. Day 5 note: moving or not. Post score Day 10. Gain. Follow-up if post score is under 12 or a motor concern.

Cycle: _____ Lead teacher: _____ Dates: _____

#	Student	Hand	Pre /24	Day 5 note	Post /24	Gain	Follow-up
1							
2							
3							
4							
5							
6							
7							
8							
9							
10							
11							
12							
13							
14							
15							
16							
17							
18							
19							
20							
21							
22							
23							
24							
25							
26							
27							
28							
29							
30							
31							
32							

Average pre-test: _____ Average post-test: _____ Average gain: _____ Students under 12 on post-test: _____

Daily checklist and warm-up card

The hour

0 to 5, set-up and warm-up. Posture call: feet, back, arms, paper, helper hand. Grip check. Warm-up below.

5 to 15, direct teaching. Model on the board three times, say the pathway out loud. Air writing, desk writing, one on paper.

15 to 35, guided practice. Worksheet of the day. Circulate in a loop: posture, grip, then formation. One correction per student per pass.

35 to 50, applied writing. Sentence, paragraph or dictation on lined paper using today's target.

50 to 57, self-check and feedback. Student circles the best letter or word. One star, one wish per student, in pencil or green.

57 to 60, tracker and clean-up. Progress chart box coloured, sheets into the folder.

Warm-up (5 minutes, read to the group)

Shoulders: roll back five times, forward five times.

Wrists: circle ten times each way, then shake the hands out.

Fingers: squeeze a fist tight, open wide, ten times. Touch each finger to the thumb, forward and back, three rounds.

Pencil walk: hold the pencil at the tip, walk the fingers to the top and back without the other hand.

Air letters: three letters from yesterday, straight arm, big and slow, saying the pathway.

Posture call: feet, back, arms, paper, helper hand. Wait until everyone is set.

Fix one thing at a time, in this order

Posture, then grip, then pressure, then letter formation, then size, then baseline, then spacing. Keep the same wish until it is fixed.

Ready to write

- 1.** Feet flat on the floor.
- 2.** Back against the chair.
- 3.** Both arms on the desk.
- 4.** Paper tilted. Top to the right if you write with your right hand, top to the left if you write with your left hand.
- 5.** Helper hand holds the paper still.
- 6.** Pencil rests on the middle finger, held by the thumb and the index finger, two fingers from the tip.
- 7.** Fingers bent and relaxed. No white knuckles.
- 8.** Light grey line. No grooves on the back of the page.
- 9.** Tall, small or tail? Every letter sits on the line. One finger between words.